

The 1999 Bern Tech Conference is a crucial point in Tony Stark's past. That's where he meets the brilliant, beautiful Maya Hansen—and A.I.M. founder Aldrich Killian, who later develops the deadly Extremis process.

The clothing, haircuts, and other details of this scene were all carefully crafted to evoke the period. "That was a lot of fun to do," Bill Brzeski says. "It was supposed to be Bern, Switzerland, and we found this great hotel right in Miami, in South Beach. It was built in the '80s and hadn't been renovated in a while. It had a strange, quasi-European feeling to it. It had this great circular ballroom.

"We added all the graphics, which were from the period. And that period was just on the cusp of the technology explosion, right around the time of the tech-boom crash. It's always fun to do period things.

"All the characters in the movie are set up in the tech conference. The movie takes off from there."

**Rob McKinnon concept art**